

SENDKIT DOCS

ESP matching, honestly assessed

ESP matching sends from a Gmail mailbox to a Gmail recipient, or Outlook to Outlook, instead of crossing between the two. It costs nothing to turn on. Here is what it actually does, honestly, and what it does not.

The theory

Google and Microsoft are believed to weigh mail from within their own ecosystem a little differently than mail crossing between providers. Gmail to Gmail traffic supposedly moves along paths both ends already trust. It is a reasonable theory, and since matching mailboxes to leads is just a setting, acting on it costs nothing.

The honest verdict

NO DRESSING THIS UP

Sometimes it lands, sometimes it does not. Every month can read as a different deliverability story, even with ESP matching switched on and nothing else changed. Inbox providers update spam filtering constantly, and no single setting, including this one, holds a fixed, provable effect month over month.

That is not a reason to skip it. It is a reason not to expect it to be the fix when something else about a campaign is broken. Bad list quality, tired copy, or a mailbox with a shaky health score will outweigh whatever ESP matching buys you.

What to actually do

01 Turn it on

It is free, it can only help at the margins, and there is no real downside to matching sender and recipient ESPs where you can.

02 Do not treat it as a deliverability strategy on its own

It is one small lever next to warm-up, health scores, list validation, and copy quality, not a replacement for any of them.

03 Watch your actual reply rate, not a belief about the setting

If replies are healthy, whatever mix of settings you are running is working. If they are not, look at mailbox health and list quality before touching this setting again.

WHY THIS WORKS ON SENDKIT

No platform, including SendKit, can promise guaranteed inbox placement, and we will not pretend otherwise. What we do give you is real, transparent health scores and isolated dedicated IPs, so when a month's deliverability shifts, you can see whether it is your mailboxes, your list, or genuinely just a rough month, instead of guessing.

Flip ESP matching to auto on one campaign

Turn the setting on for one active campaign and compare its reply rate against a campaign running without it.

[Open campaign settings](#)